LOG FILE ANALYSIS FOR ONLINE STORES, EXPLAINED SIMPLY

See what Googlebot actually crawls. Not what you hope it crawls.

```
access.log

66.249.66.1     [21/Dec 08:14:02] "GET /products/blue-hoodie"     200
                                  Googlebot/2.1
82.31.10.7      [21/Dec 08:14:05] "GET /collections/hoodies"      200
                                  Chrome/131
66.249.66.1     [21/Dec 08:14:09] "GET /shop/?orderby=price"      200
                                  Googlebot/2.1
```

INSIDE

1 Filter to Googlebot

2 Group URLs by type

3 Find crawl waste

4 Find neglected pages

5 Check status codes

6 Act, then compare

SWIPE →



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WHAT A LOG FILE IS

Your server records every request: URL, time, status code, user agent. **Including Googlebot's.**

access.log

```
66.249.66.1     [21/Dec 08:14:02]  "GET /products…   200
                                   Googlebot/2.1
82.31.10.7      [21/Dec 08:14:05]  "GET /collecti…   200
                                   Chrome/131
66.249.66.1     [21/Dec 08:14:09]  "GET /shop/?or…   200
                                   Googlebot/2.1
203.0.113.42    [21/Dec 08:14:11]  "GET /product/…   404
                                   Googlebot/2.1
```

URL **Time** **Status code** **User agent**

Highlighted rows = requests that say they are **Googlebot**.



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WHERE TO GET THE DATA

WooCommerce: access logs from your host or CDN.
Shopify: no raw logs, so use GSC Crawl Stats instead.

WooCommerce

Access logs from your host or CDN

`access.log` `cdn-logs.gz`

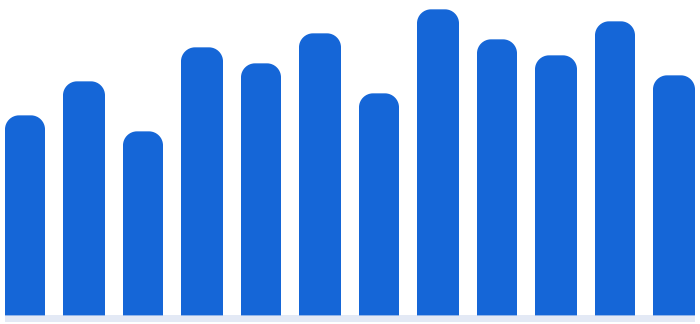
```
host · access.log
66.249.66.1
"GET /products/blue-hoodi…
82.31.10.7
"GET /collections/hoodies"
```

Shopify

No raw logs

GSC · SETTINGS · CRAWL STATS

Total crawl requests



By response

By file type By purpose



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STEP 1: FILTER TO GOOGLEBOT

Filter by user agent, then verify with reverse DNS. **Fake Googlebots are common.**

All requests
Shoppers, bots, tools

User agent contains “Googlebot”
Step 1: filter

Reverse DNS verified
Step 2: verify

Reverse DNS check

IP	Host	
66.249.66.1	crawl-66-249-66-1.googlebot.com	✓ Real
203.0.113.42	unknown-host.example.net	✕ Fake

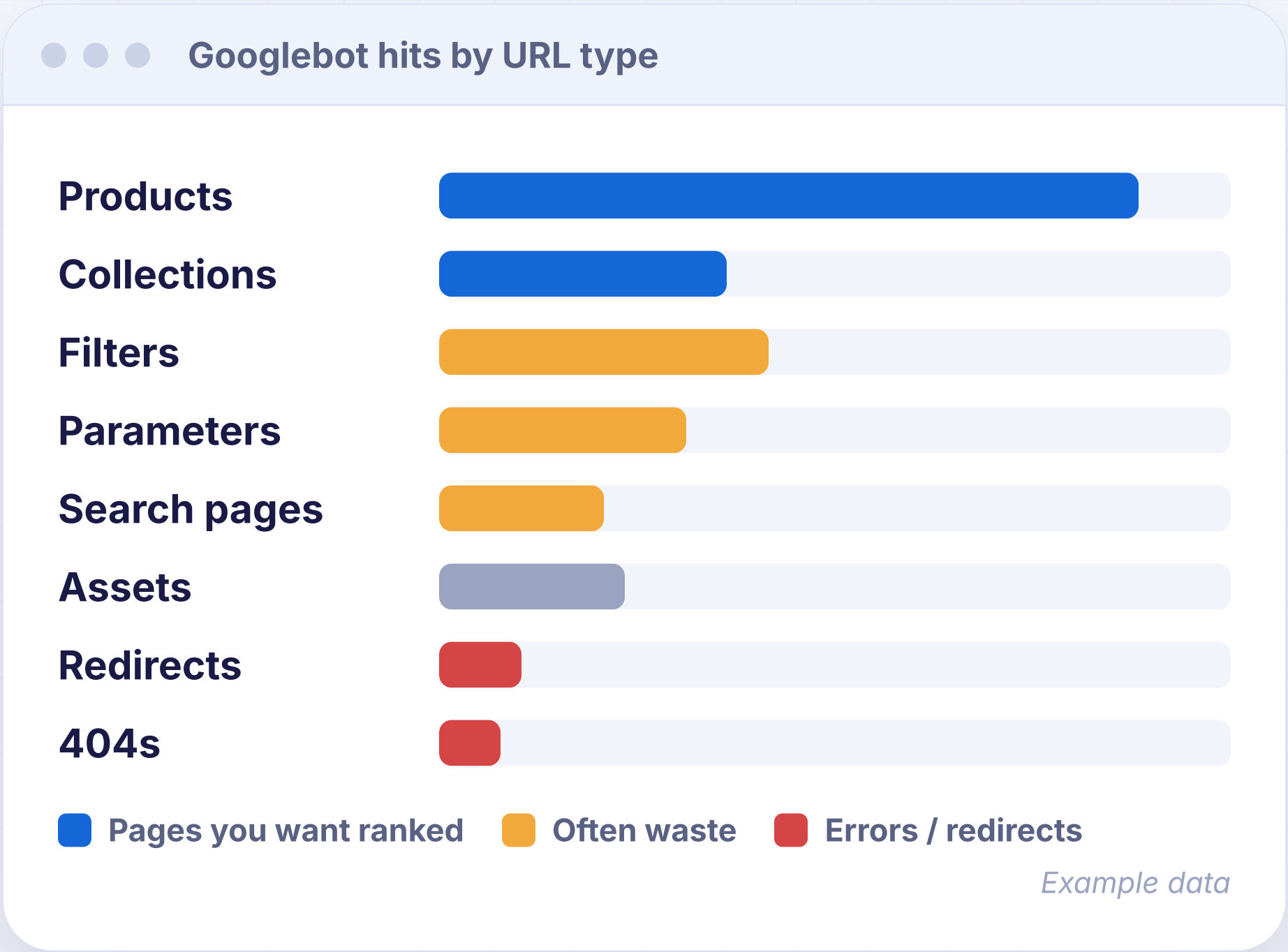


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STEP 2: GROUP URLS BY TYPE

Products, collections, filters, parameters, search pages, assets, redirects, 404s.





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STEP 3: FIND CRAWL WASTE

High share of hits on ?orderby=, ?filter_, /?s= or tag pages = **Google's time spent on URLs you don't want ranked.**

URLs you want ranked | **Crawl waste**

Top Googlebot hits · example

/shop/?orderby=price	Waste
/shop/?filter_color=red	Waste
/?s=hoodie	Waste
/product-tag/sale/	Waste
/products/blue-hoodie	Wanted



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STEP 4: FIND NEGLECTED PAGES

Key products and collections with few or no Googlebot hits.
Usually weak internal links.

Key pages · Googlebot hits (30 days)

Page	Hits	
/collections/hoodies	Many	Healthy
/collections/winter-coats	Few	Neglected
/products/wool-scarf	None	Neglected
/collections/gift-sets	Few	Neglected

USUAL CAUSE **Weak internal links**



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STEP 5: CHECK STATUS CODES

Googlebot hitting 301 chains, 404s or 5xx errors. **Fix the links causing them.**

Status codes Googlebot keeps hitting

`/product/old-hoodie/`

301 → 301 → 200 — Chain

`/product/red-cap/`

404 — Broken link

`/collections/sale`

5xx — Server error

Fix the links causing them Menus · Product cards · Sitemaps



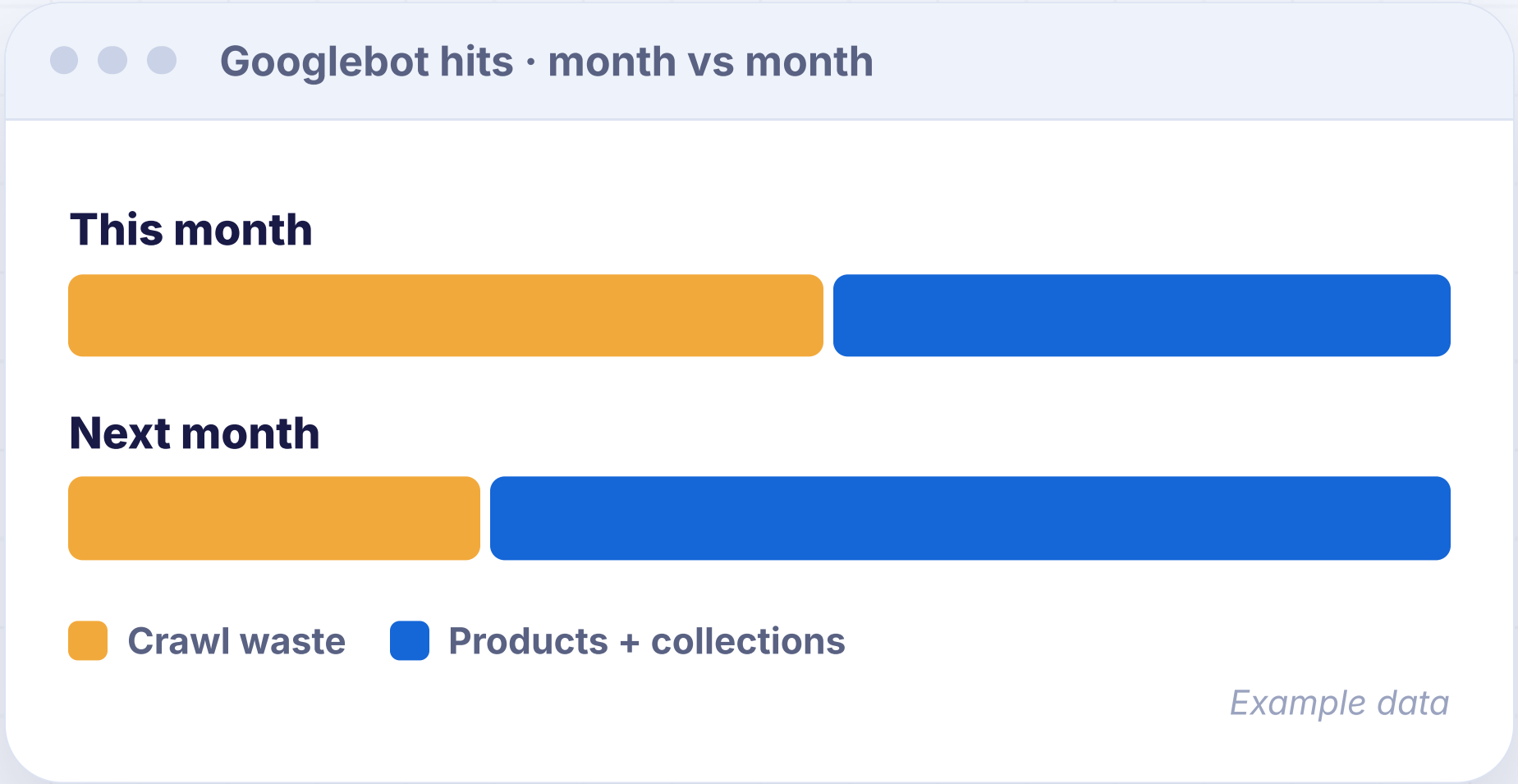
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STEP 6: ACT, THEN COMPARE

Fix links, robots rules or canonicals. **Compare the next month's logs to see if crawling shifted.**

Fix links | **Robots rules** | **Canonicals**



✓ **Crawling shifted to the pages you want ranked**



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FREE STARTER KIT

GET THE STARTER KIT

“LOGFILES”

Comment for the **sheet and URL filter list.**

LOG FILE ANALYSIS STARTER KIT

URL	Type	Googlebot hits	Status
/products/blue-hoodie	Product	[X]	200
/collections/hoodies	Collection	[X]	200
/shop/?orderby=price	Parameter	[X]	200

FILTER LIST `?orderby=` `?filter_` `/?s=` `/product-tag/`

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